

Usability testing the iPad

- 7 participants with 3+ months experience with iPhones
- Signed an informed consent form explaining:
 - what the participant would be asked to do;
 - the length of time needed for the study;
 - the compensation that would be offered for participating;
 - participants' right to withdraw from the study at any time;
 - a promise that the person's identity would not be disclosed; and
 - an agreement that the data collected would be confidential and would be available to only the evaluators
- Then they were asked to explore the iPad
- Next they were asked to perform randomly assigned specified tasks

Examples of the tasks

App or website	Task
iBook	Download a free copy of <i>Alice's Adventures in Wonderland</i> and read through the first few pages.
Craigslist	Find some free mulch for your garden.
eBay	You want to buy a new iPad on eBay. Find one that you could buy from a reputable seller.
<i>Time</i> Magazine	Browse through the magazine and find the best pictures of the week.
Epicurious	You want to make an apple pie for tonight. Find a recipe and see what you need to buy in order to prepare it.
Kayak	You are planning a trip to Death Valley in May this year. Find a hotel located in the park or close to the park.

Table 14.1 Examples of some of the tests used in the iPad evaluation (adapted from Budiu and Nielsen, 2010).

Source: Copyright Nielsen Norman Group, from report available at <http://www.nngroup.com/reports/>.

Example of the equipment



Figure 14.6 The setup used in the Chicago usability testing sessions

Source: Copyright Nielsen Norman Group, from report available at <http://www.nngroup.com/reports/>.

Problems and actions

- Problems detected:
 - Accessing the Web was difficult
 - Lack of affordance and feedback
 - Getting lost
 - Knowing where to tap
- Actions by evaluators:
 - Reported to developers
 - Made available to public on nngroup.com
- Accessibility for all users important